

After the Love Has Gone -- Earth, Wind & Fire

I Am, 1979. ~66 BPM, est.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

This is a slow, lush R&B ballad with dense jazz-leaning chords, many key shifts, strings, and big stacked vocals. The bass is the opposite of the funk patch. It's warm, round, and sustained, and it supports the harmony more than the groove.

Long notes and smooth passing tones through the changes. No snap, no pop.

Why not the EWF-Funk patch

EWF-Funk is bright, tightly compressed, and voiced at 800Hz for finger attack. That's right for September. On this song it would poke out of the arrangement.

This patch pulls the top end down, lightens the compression, and trades punch for bloom.

AMP: Mess Bass (Mesa/Boogie Bass 400) + CAB: TC410 IR (User IR 9)

Bass 400 has a smooth, full-range, hi-fi clean voice. It suits a polished late-70s studio ballad.

TC410 is flat with a mild 100Hz lift. It's a neutral cab that won't add hi-mid bite.

- Gain: 22. Fully clean.
- Bass: 60. Warm and full under the chords.
- Middle: 50. Neutral, so the passing tones read through the changes.
- Treble: 42. Rounded. Finger noise and string zing stay down.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 10. Barely there. Long sustained notes must decay naturally.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 60.

Light leveling so sustained notes hold even through the bar. Much softer than the COMP4 squash on the funk patch.

DST -- off. No grit anywhere in this song.

AMP -- Mess Bass, always on. Gain 22, Bass 60, Middle 50, Treble 42, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 9 (TC410), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +2, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: -3, VOL: 52.

Warm lows, a touch of 800Hz so moving lines stay defined, top rolled off.

MOD -- off. The strings and keys already carry the sheen.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- Plate, on CTL.

Mix: 20, Decay: 45, Damp: 55, Trail: on.

Smooth plate for the big choruses. Damp 55 keeps the tail dark so it blooms without smearing the low end.

CTL footswitch

One module on CTL: RVB (Plate).

- **CTL off**: verses. Close, warm, and dry under the lead vocal. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on**: choruses and the final key-change swells. Plate opens the bass into the same space as the strings and stacked vocals.

Engage at each "After the love has gone" chorus. Back off for the verses.